

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 667

By Bowling

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Colonel Thomas B. Vaughn of Warren County.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were saddened to learn of the passing of Colonel Thomas B. Vaughn, a distinguished soldier, educator, writer, and philanthropist whose life of service left an enduring mark on Warren County and the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Colonel Vaughn, a proud native of Warren County, began his military career as a private in the Tennessee Army National Guard before entering the United States Army, where he rose quickly through the ranks, earning promotion to Staff Sergeant at the age of twenty-two and graduating with distinction from Infantry Officer Candidate School in 1962; and

WHEREAS, over the course of a remarkable military career spanning service on five continents, Colonel Vaughn served as a two-term combat veteran of the Vietnam War and earned numerous commendations, including the Legion of Merit with oak leaf cluster, Bronze Star Medal with "V" device and four oak leaf clusters, Purple Heart, Defense Meritorious Service Medal, Army Meritorious Service Medal with four oak leaf clusters, Air Medal with "V" device, Combat Infantry Badge, Expert Infantry Badge, Parachutist Badge, Ranger Tab, and General Staff Identification Badge; and

WHEREAS, Colonel Vaughn further distinguished himself academically, earning a bachelor's degree from Omaha University in 1967 and a master's degree in political science from the University of Kansas in 1972 and graduating from the prestigious Army War College in 1982. In 1984, he was placed on the Honor Roll of the Infantry Officer Candidate Hall of Fame at Fort Benning, Georgia, in recognition of his exemplary leadership and service; and

WHEREAS, following his retirement from the Army, Colonel Vaughn continued his commitment to public service by teaching American history, Tennessee history, state and local government, and public speaking at the college level and by serving as a radio host on WBMC and WCPI, where he informed and engaged the community; and

WHEREAS, a gifted writer and lifelong student of literature, Colonel Vaughn contributed numerous columns to the *Southern Standard*, including his long-running *My Turn* series, and was known for his thoughtful commentary, poetry, and speechwriting, even assisting leaders at the Pentagon; and

WHEREAS, Colonel Vaughn was also a respected figure in the music industry, serving as President and CEO of Bob White Music, Inc., where his leadership helped sustain the company and support the careers of numerous artists; his friendship and collaboration with Jacky Jack White spanned decades and reflected his loyalty, humor, and dedication to excellence; and

WHEREAS, deeply committed to charitable work, Colonel Vaughn supported the Warren County Animal Control and Adoption Center, the Tennessee Fisher House Foundation, and other community causes, demonstrating a lifelong devotion to helping others and improving the lives of those around him; and

WHEREAS, Colonel Vaughn was a devoted family man, a member of New Union Church, and a beloved husband, father, and grandfather who cherished time with his family, especially his "bonus daughters" and grandchildren, whose activities he faithfully supported from the sidelines; and

WHEREAS, in his later years, Colonel Vaughn enjoyed traveling, beach vacations, Scrabble tournaments, and the simple joys of life shared with those he loved, embodying gratitude, generosity, and a spirit of service until his final days; and

WHEREAS, Colonel Thomas B. Vaughn leaves behind a legacy of courage, leadership, scholarship, and kindness, and it is fitting that we pause to honor his extraordinary life and service to his community, his State, and his nation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Colonel Thomas B. Vaughn, extend our sympathy to his family and friends, and celebrate the life of a Tennessean whose service and character will long be remembered.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.